

Singapore Tourism Board
Year in Review 2021
25 January 2022

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Over the last 2 years, tourism businesses played key role in national fight against COVID-19

More than 90 hotels and MICE venues have served as isolation facilities, providing rooms to accommodate over **488,000** stays

Some **250** tourist guides signed up as Safe Distancing Ambassadors (SDAs) to keep tourism businesses and precincts safe

Over **600** cruise industry employees worked to house some **8,200** recovered migrant workers on the world's first ever cruise dormitories

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Singapore's tourism sector remained resilient despite the challenges posed by COVID-19

In 2021, STB worked with the tourism sector to pivot decisively to the domestic market, preserved jobs, and trialed innovative ways to reopen safely to international visitors

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Driving domestic consumption through SingapoRediscovers

singaporediscovers

Content partnerships, marketing activations and advertising campaigns garnered over **71.6 million views** across different platforms and formats, raising awareness of Singapore's diverse lifestyle offerings and encouraging locals to explore different sides of Singapore. This includes **over 2.5 million unique visitors** to the SRD website.

Niantic partnership to promote exploration through Pokémon GO



Partnering with Burpple to feature local food trails



Encourage locals to rediscover Singapore's precinct offerings through Merli Go Round



singaporediscovers VOUCHERS

460 tourism businesses participated in the SingapoRediscovers (SRV) scheme, including **46** attractions, **173** tour operators, and **241** hotels offering more than **800** SRV-eligible products.

About **1.9** million Singaporeans have used their SRVs, making about **2.6 million transactions.** Close to **$300 million** in SRV transactions were recorded, including **$180 million in Vouchers** and about **$120 million in out-of-pocket payments** for SRV bookings.

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Forging strategic partnerships to amplify SingapoRediscovers

CROSS-SECTOR PARTNERSHIPS

STB-Mastercard's "Rediscover Priceless® Singapore" marketing partnership

- Promote domestic tourism businesses based on consumer insights, spending behaviour and trends.
- Over **100** curated deals, including **16** new and exclusive Priceless Experiences, aimed at Families and Young Professionals who make up half of local Mastercard cardholders.

STB-DBS partnership to stimulate tourism & drive SingapoRediscovers promotions

- Personalised itineraries and destination content based on Intelligent Banking capabilities, to encourage locals to explore Singapore's offerings.
- Feature more than **70** SRV Klook deals on DBS Travel & Leisure Marketplace.

DBS
Live more, Bank less

Partnering with Chope to promote F&B establishments in key tourism precincts

- Launched in Dec 2020, the partnership featured over **200** dining establishments in precincts such as Chinatown, Little India, and Katong/Joo Chiat.
- Over **7 million** impressions, resulting in **$1.3 million incremental restaurant revenue**.

chope

Partnering iQiyi to encourage exploration of Singapore's cultural precincts

- Drive awareness of precinct offerings through assets based on iQiyi's first Southeast Asian original, The Ferryman: Legends of Nanyang, including murals and thematic tours.
- Specially-created Tiktok filters launched in September saw more than **12 million** impressions.

iQIYI
iQ.com

Renewal of STB-Disney partnership to anchor unique events and experiences

- Continued collaboration with The Walt Disney Company Southeast Asia (since 2017)
- International premiere of ***Pop-Up Disney!*** A Mickey Celebration, a tribute to Mickey Mouse. This exhibition features 7 themed rooms, one of it Singapore-inspired and designed by local artist, WhenIWasFour.

Disney

Designing innovative tours to appeal to locals and visitors

OPPORTUNITY AMIDST CRISIS

Strong domestic demand for local tours

- Number of domestic tour participants grew month-on-month by between **30 to 55 per cent** from January to April, prior to implementation of Phase 2 (Heightened Alert). Robust recovery in November and December, with local tours participation growing **89** and **90** per cent month-on-month.

- Number of domestic tour participants reached close to **320,000** in 2021.

- **42** new Travel Agent licences and **71** Tourist Guide licences were issued in 2021.
  - The Untamed Path, established in March, focuses on wildlife and ecological tours in Singapore
  - Seek Sophie, established in November, is a local start-up OTA that focuses on small lifestyle and tourism businesses in Southeast Asia

NEW INNOVATIVE TOUR CONCEPTS

Tour Experience Innovation Lab (TEIL)

- **5 new tours** were borne out of collaboration between tour operators and arts practitioners supported by the **STB-NAC Performing Arts Tours Pilot Grant.**
- **SentoSights**, a collaboration between SDC and tour operators, with **10 unique new tour** experiences focusing on heritage, sustainability, marine conservation and biodiversity.



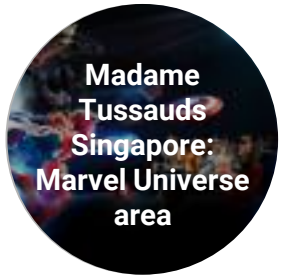


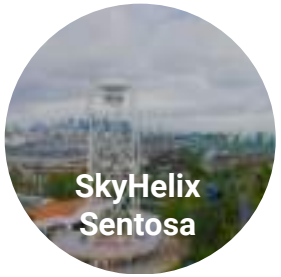
New and enhanced experiences that cater to every interest

NEW AND ENHANCED ATTRACTIONS







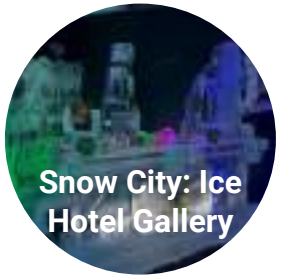












NEW PRODUCTS TO MEET EVOLVING CONSUMER NEEDS

Songkran Festival campaign by Wild Wild Wet

- In the month of April, the park was decked out with Thai-themed décor, photos ops and F&B so locals could enjoy the festival without having to travel.



Wedding photoshoot package by Gardens by the Bay

- Introduced to target new market segment, which includes an accompanying Safety Ambassador to ensure a safe experience during the photoshoot, and buggy transport.



Photo credit: Jax Long and Elaine Chai

Weekday Annual Pass by Kiztopia

- To drive weekday demand, Kiztopia launched the special pass to entice visitors with unlimited entries and play time.



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Enhancing the staycation experience

UNIQUE EXPERIENCES FOR DIFFERENT INTERESTS

CoComelon-themed restaurant and staycation experience by Swissotel The Stamford

- World's first CoComelon-themed café to target young families.
- Aside from converting tables into booths designed as school buses, the cafe also offers a specially-designed menu inspired by the cartoon, merchandise and photo wall for an immersive experience.



Augmented Reality (AR) art tour by Ritz-Carlton, Millennia Singapore

- World's only AR hotel art tour.
- Visitors can interact virtually with 10 artworks in the hotel's collection, supplemented by computer generated graphics and sound as well as written or audio narratives about the piece and artist.



Amoy Hotel Explorer Staycation

- Cultural staycation experience through its collaboration with precinct partners such as Persp8ctives by 8th Wave, Little Art Connoisseur and more.
- Discover hidden temples and learn about the history of Chinatown through the lens of coolies or learn the meaning behind traditional Chinese motifs by creating personalised tote bags.



Immersive virtual experience stay by Raffles Hotel Singapore

- Virtual interactive play staged in collaboration with Double Confirm productions and Sight Lines Entertainment.
- Guests take part in an interactive treasure hunt that combines virtual and physical gameplay during their stay.



Safe and compelling cruise offerings

ROBUST GROWTH

- Cruises rebounded strongly, and Singapore saw over **400,000 passengers** set sail on close to **300 cruise sailings**.
- Successful adoption of CruiseSafe since 2020, with **no COVID-19 clusters to date**.
- Under the Sea Crew Vaccination (SEAVAX) Initiative, all cruise crew are provided vaccination



Passion Made Possible

Singapore Tourism Board

Growing capabilities and opportunities for safe MICE events

ESTABLISHING BEST-IN-CLASS STANDARDS FOR SAFE BUSINESS EVENTS

STB's efforts to reopen the MICE industry safely

- STB launched the **Safe Business Events Framework** in 2020 and continues to assess and regulate all pilot events.
  - In 2021, **more than 200 MICE event pilots** have been completed with close to **50,000 attendees**
- Trialed new, innovative safety protocols at selected MICE pilot events to pave the way for reopening of the industry.
- Worked closely with SACEOS to support the industry-led accreditation programme **SG SafeEvent Standards Certification.**
  - More than **80 organisations** have registered interest
  - **40 organisations** certified
  - **3,200 Ambassadors** certified to date

Notable events held in 2021



Asia Tech X Singapore



Bloomberg New Economy Forum



gamescom asia



Milken Institute Asia Summit



PCMA Convening Leaders

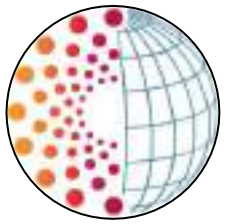
Notable events secured in 2021



FIND – Design Fair Asia (2022 – 2024)



Gastech 2023



Global Health Security Conference 2022



SILMO Singapore (2023 – 2025)



transport logistic and air cargo Southeast Asia 2023

Piloting innovative leisure events for locals and visitors

PRIORITISING SAFETY, REIMAGINING EXPERIENCES



Photo credit:
Getty Images – Yong Teck Lim

HSBC Women's World Championship

- First international professional golf tournament in Asia since onset of COVID-19
- Piloted robust event-specific Safe Management Measures (SMMs) with **250 corporate guests** in attendance.
- Generated IMV of **$372 million**



Standard Chartered Singapore Marathon

- Second year in hybrid format with physical and virtual components. The physical component was the first large scale in-person mass participation event since the onset of COVID-19, with **4,000** local runners across 4 sessions to ensure safety
- The Virtual Club had **more than 58,000 unique participants from 38 countries**



Singapore Food Festival

- Hybrid event doubled in scale as compared to 2020, with 82 satellite activations locally
- **2,600 physical attendees**, 49 new product launches and activations in 11 countries
- Generated IMV of over **$5.3 million**



Photo credit:
ONE Championship

ONE Championship

- Total of **8 live events** held from Apr to Dec 21, broadcast from Singapore to **more than 150** countries, an average broadcast reach of **23 million viewers per event**
- Identified as one of the first spectator sports events under the VDS+Test Protocol pilot



Major esports events

- Several closed-door productions of popular game titles (Mobile Legends Bang Bang M2 World Championship, Dota 2 Singapore Major, and Wild Rift Horizon Cup) hosted in Singapore
- Record breaking viewership statistics including the highest number of concurrent views in esports history of more than **5.4 million** for the finals of Free Fire World Series
- MLBB M3 World Championship (Dec 2021) was the first international esports event in Singapore to have a **live audience** since the pandemic began

Reimagining the future of Singapore tourism

PARTNERSHIPS

Partnership with Airbnb Experiences to reimagine travel experiences



- Two-year MOU signed in 2020 to co-promote and grow a range of unique Airbnb Experiences hosted by locals, and co-marketing of destination Singapore.
- Global storytelling campaign rolled out in July 2021 to more than **55 million fans** worldwide, featuring Jada Pinkett Smith and Willow Smith discovering Singapore through Airbnb Experiences.
- Encouraged local tourism businesses to reimagine the future of tourism by pivoting to new business models, with **25** experiences by homegrown brands under the **Made With Passion** campaign.

CONVERSATIONS

SingapoReimagine Global Conversations – providing a global stage for industry stories and experiences

singapore reimagine global conversations

- **Reimagine Experiences**, the first forum under the SingapoReimagine Global Conversations B2B thought leadership platform, launched in Sep 2021 with a video-on-demand, 4-part episodic format.
- Reflect the changing needs and concerns of travellers, address new travel themes and trends, and lead transformation in the industry by highlighting industry game changers to inspire the global audience and spur conversations.
- STB also held localised forums overseas, including in the USA and United Arab Emirates.

Preserving good jobs and core capabilities

REDEPLOYING MANPOWER & PRESERVING LIVELIHOODS

More than **5,000** workers from the hotel and attractions industries were temporarily deployed to other jobs through **NTUC**, in collaboration with both private and public agencies.

With the help of Workforce Singapore (WSG) and NTUC's Employment and Employability Institute (e2i), more than **1,800** tourism jobseekers were placed through **WSG's and NTUC e2i's career matching services.**

Some **13,000** local workers were employed by tourism companies as part of the **Jobs Growth Initiative.**

PREPARING TOURISM WORKERS TO MEET NEW DEMANDS

More than **61,000** training places supported under SkillsFuture Singapore' **Enhanced Training Support Package.**

STB's **Training Industry Professionals in Tourism (TIP-iT) Grant** supported close to **800** tourism workers across **59** projects.

STB granted **more than 160 SkillsFuture Study Awards** to employees in the tourism sector, to encourage locals to deepen tourism skills and capabilities.

Close to **250** trainees onboarded the traineeship programme with tourism companies under the **SGUnited Traineeships** and **SGUnited Mid-Career Pathways (Company Attachment) Programmes**

REDESIGNING JOBS & SUPPORTING INNOVATION

More than **140** tourism companies tapped on WSG's **Career Conversion Programmes** to help more than **1,300** workers take on redesigned and enhanced roles.

More than **200** projects supported under STB's **Business Improvement Fund (BIF).**

Launched the **Tourism Sector Capability Development Roadmap** together with key tourism associations and NTUC

**all figures cover 2020-2021*

Driving digital transformation to improve the visitor experience

LAUNCH OF HYBRID INNOVATION SPACE TCUBE

- Initiatives under Tcube supported **more than 1,000** local tourism companies:

Singapore Tourism Accelerator

- Supported 34 start-ups to develop 45 industry solutions across 4 cohorts.

Data Transformation Programme

- Benefitted 60 tourism companies with validated Proofs-of-Concept.

Data Analytics Shift (DASH)

- Onboarded 15 tourism companies undergoing 17 data-related projects across 4 runs.

Lighthouse Programme

- Worked with 5 tourism companies to support digital and customer experience transformation.

Tourism Information and Services Hub

- Over 6,900 businesses which span across 100 countries and 22 industries have been onboarded.

IMPROVED DIGITAL FEATURES FOR SAFE TRAVEL

- Launched features on VisitSingapore.com and VS mobile app to help visitors navigate COVID requirements and reduce friction of travelling.





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Pursuing key trends in travel and tourism to appeal to changing consumer sentiments

SETTING OUT AMBITIONS FOR SUSTAINABILITY

- STB became a member of Global Sustainable Tourism Council (GSTC)
- Working with SHA to develop a hotel sustainability roadmap with strategies and targets for the industry, which will be launched in 2022.
- Built thought leadership in sustainability through in-market B2B events e.g. in US, UK, Dubai and Vietnam



Sustainability commitments by industry

- **Sentosa Development Corporation** and its island partners have set the ambitious target of achieving carbon neutrality by 2030, while **Resorts World Sentosa** secured GSTC Destination Criteria and Industry Criteria for Hotels certification, the first tourism business to do so in Southeast Asia.
- **Mandai Wildlife Group** rolled out initiatives such as its Mandai Environmental Sustainability Strategy and green procurement roadmap
- **Pan Pacific Orchard** will be a zero waste hotel when it opens in 2022, with a rainwater-harvesting system, compactor to transform food waste into nutrient water for the hotel's sky gardens, and energy saving technology such as solar cells

BECOMING A LEADING URBAN WELLNESS HAVEN

- Developed Wellness Tourism Roadmap with identified strategies and initiatives from now till 2025

ClassPass partnership

classpass

- Launched one-year partnership to jointly promote Singapore's wellness offerings.
- Thus far, onboarded more than **80** local wellness businesses across a range of wellness categories

Industry efforts to cater to growing demand



- **New wellness-centric hotels** e.g. Oasia Resort Sentosa and PARKROYAL Marina Bay
- **Holistic wellness retreats** e.g. Recharge Staycation by Grand Hyatt Hotel x Kydra; and An Emergence of Self by Blue Sky Escapes
- **Urban fitness experiences** e.g. Rooftop yoga conducted by Virgin Active instructors at Sands SkyPark (Marina Bay Sands)



2021 Tourism Performance

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2021 Tourism Sector Performance



VISITOR ARRIVALS

330,000

Source: STB

TOURISM RECEIPTS

S$1.9 Billion*

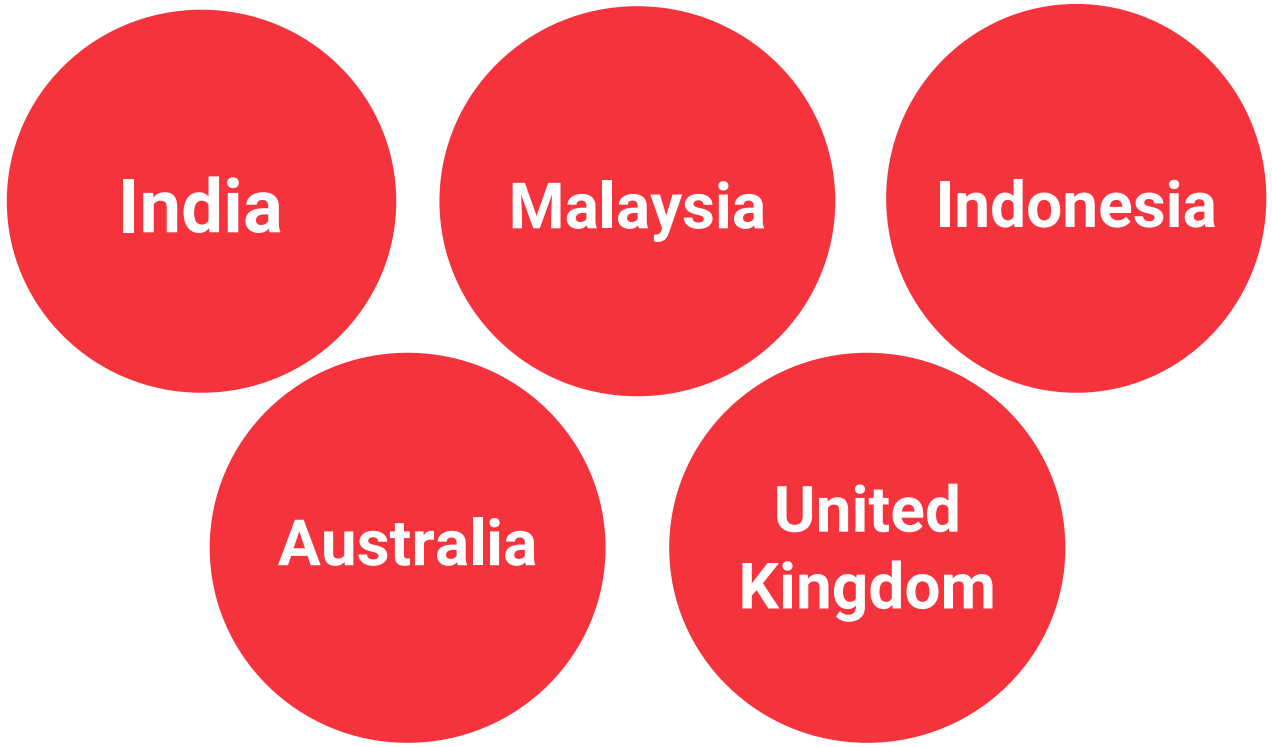
*preliminary estimate
Source: STB

IVA increased 221 per cent in the last three quarters of 2021, compared to the same period in 2020.
TR for the second and third quarter of 2021 is 92 per cent higher than the same period in 2020.

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Healthy demand from VTL markets

Top 5 Markets by VTP (Air) applications
(short term visitor)
as of 31 December 2021



- **Healthy demand** from VTL markets since the introduction of Vaccinated Travel Lanes (VTLs) from September 2021.
- From September to December 2021, more than **100,000 Vaccinated Travel Passes** have been issued to applicants with short-term visas travelling under VTL (Air).
- Approximately **two-thirds** of these applicants travelled to Singapore by 31 December 2021.

** Short-term visitors from markets that are Unilaterally Open to Singapore are not required to apply for VTP.*

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Marketing spotlight

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Helping international audiences experience Singapore from afar

THAILAND



Singapore Virtual Tour

- Launched a virtual tour series that pairs a Thai KOL with a Thai-speaking Singaporean guide to explore Singapore neighbourhoods.
- Ep 1 on Katong/Joo Chiat drew **433,000 views** and close to **3.2 million impressions.** More than **600** participants took part in the Live Q&A on YouTube.

MALAYSIA



Hello From Singapore web series

- Featured 10 Singapore companies that shared about how they had reimagined their business or craft.
- Leveraged the series to highlight tourism industry updates and share about Singapore neighbourhoods
- Generated **3 million views** and **IMV of SGD$36,000**.

INDIA



Chhota Bheem's Adventures in Singapore

- Collaboration with Voot Kids and Green Gold Animation to create a 7-part webisode series that brings iconic Indian comic character Chhota Bheem to Singapore, engaging families and children across India.
- The video series and e-books received **more than 7 million views** and **IMV of SGD$218,000**.

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Diverse marketing activities to keep Singapore top-of-mind

AUSTRALIA



Honey Bean Coffee Gin Liqueur

Collaboration between Australian celebrity chef, Anna Polyviou and Singapore's first gin distillery, Tanglin Gin to develop a limited-edition liqueur developed from iconic flavours and ingredients from both countries.

As of 9 Nov, there were 20 earned media articles, with a total reach of **17.18 million** and IMV of **AUD$120,000**.

MAINLAND CHINA



STB-Ctrip joint marketing

Series of joint marketing campaigns to pre-sell Singapore travel products, such as hotels and attraction tickets.

Two activations in February and May 2021 saw over **18,000** bookings from Chinese consumers for future travel to Singapore.

Singapore Food Festival

Partnership with Shangri-La group of hotels across 7 Chinese cities to promote Singapore cuisine at these hotels during SFF, resulting in more than **40,000** dine-in bookings.

JAPAN



SJ55: Celebrating 55 years of Singapore-Japan Relations

Series of activations to coincide with 55 years of relations between both countries, to provide opportunity for Japanese consumers to explore Singapore's offerings.

SingapoReimagine ULTRAMAN campaign leverages Ultraman's popularity to generate interest in Singapore. Video series featuring Ultraman and an original character modeled after the Merlion launched generated nearly **1 million views** within 3 weeks of launch

SJ55 activations and campaigns generated IMV of over **SGD$2.1 million**.

Ramping up efforts to inspire VTL travel to Singapore

UNITED KINGDOM



Raya & The Last Dragon

STB London collaborated with The Walt Disney Company (UK) for the release of the film **Raya & The Last Dragon**, to promote travel to Singapore in 2022. STB London also partnered with travel agent Flight Centre to further generate bookings in July-September 2021, before VTL arrangements were in place.

The Flight Centre pilot collaboration generated **3.2 million impressions**, and saw close to **SGD$270,000** in bookings for travel to Singapore in 2022.

UNITED STATES



Singapore by Stream

Viewers explored Singapore in real time with charismatic local taxi driver, Uncle Francis via streaming platform Twitch as he visits landmarks and hidden gems of Singapore such as Marina Bay Sands, Little India and more.

In total, the 4 livestream tours received **344,000 views** and were the **top 1% of all livestreams on Twitch.** Livestream generated total IMV of **US$25.3 million** and won Silver for 2021 Shark Awards.

Clubhouse: Singapore After Midnight

Intimate conversations with Singaporean tastemakers such as hawker guru K.F. Seetoh, actor Tan Kheng Hua, musician Charlie Lim, nightlife entrepreneur Vijay Mudaliar and restaurateur Willin Low.

Highlight Singapore's status as a foodie paradise, escape for culture lovers and great nightlife destination.

SOUTH KOREA



Partnership with KTO to promote bilateral tourism

Two-year MOU to co-promote both destinations and boost bilateral tourism.

VTL Marketing

Partnered with popular Korean comedian Mr Yoo Se-Yoon to address misperceptions about the Vaccinated Travel Pass application. The video campaign reached close to **400,000** views.

VTL sales campaign with Korean travel agents saw approximately **350 travellers** booking for travel within first week of launch.



Looking ahead

Marketing partnerships to encourage travel to Singapore

STB-SIA-CAG







Tripartite "Welcome Back to Singapore" partnership between STB, Singapore Airlines and Changi Airport Group

- Instill travel confidence among international VTL travellers and drive consideration and bookings for trips to Singapore.
- Campaign launched in Germany and India following the establishment of VTL.
- Campaign will continue to be launched in other VTL markets, such as Australia, Denmark, France, Netherlands, Italy, Spain, United Kingdom, United States, Switzerland, and South Korea.

STB SEA-Klook

KLOOK

Regional partnership between STB's Southeast Asia regional offices and Klook to increase visitor expenditure

- Promote destination Singapore to visitors from Southeast Asian markets (Indonesia, Malaysia, Philippines, Thailand and Vietnam).
- Increase tourism receipts on Singapore's tourism offerings following the resumption of international travel from these countries.
- Showcasing new and reimagined activities such as nature and culture-based experiences, around Singapore's key neighbourhoods.

Deepening overseas trade engagements to drive demand

SHARING WITH TRADE PARTNERS

Local stakeholders

- STB organised 3 online briefing sessions with around **200 SG tourism stakeholders** to educate them on the VTL travel arrangements and visitor journey, and share upcoming global campaigns and plans for key markets.

International stakeholders

- Organised trips to SG for trade partners in markets that launched VTLs with SG, to familiarise them with travel arrangements, and tourism and lifestyle offerings.

LEVERAGING INT'L PLAFORMS

Dubai World Expo

- Various business and trade engagements, including hosting the **International Young Lawyers Association (AIJA)** at the SG Pavilion at Expo 2020 in Dubai to drive affinity and awareness of the AJIA event in SG in 2022.

WORKING WITH TRAVEL INTERMEDIARIES

Europe





- Joint marketing campaigns with **11 OTAs and tour operators** including Expedia, eDreams, Les Maison du Voyage and Tix.nl in the Netherlands and France to drive awareness and conversion following launch of VTLs.
- A 3-week campaign with Tix.nl **doubled** the search volume on Singapore, and another 3-week campaign with Otravo led to increase in search volume of **more than 90%.**

COLLABORATING WITH OTHER DESTINATIONS





"Asia Now" Canada Campaign

- Partnered 3 Asian DMOs* (South Korea, Taiwan, Philippines) on a B2B campaign targeting Canadian leisure trade with a microsite, FB group and quarterly newsletters. The Q3 newsletter drew close to **6,000 impressions**.
- To drive awareness of SG-Canada VTL, STB launched a live virtual tour, and Virtual Game Day with prizes including Air Canada tickets to Asia, attracting the participation of **close to 50 tour operators**.

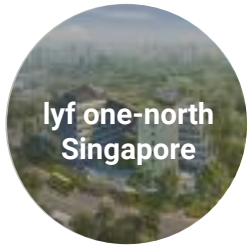
*Destination Marketing Organisation

Possible
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Forging ahead with longer-term plans

NEW CONCEPTS









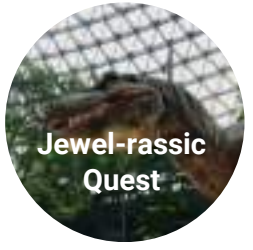






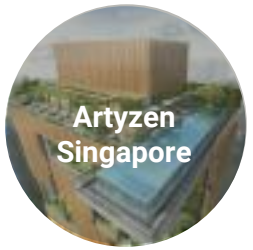


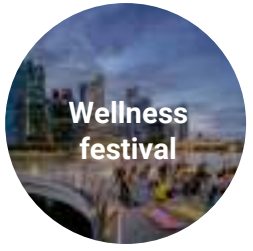












REFRESHED OFFERINGS





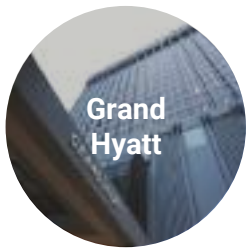












Future-proofing our tourism businesses

ENSURING PIPELINE OF HIGH QUALITY TOURISM WORKERS

STB, NTUC, WSG and e2i – with support from key Trade Associations – will launch the **Tourism Careers Hub,** a one-stop shop providing end-to-end career and training support for tourism workers and businesses, as well as individuals interested to pursue a tourism career.

Tourism Careers Hub will focus on three main areas:

1. **Job matching** within tourism sector.
2. **Develop industry-specific capabilities** to prepare tourism workforce for recovery.
3. **Encourage technology transformation and business innovation** by tourism companies to seize new growth opportunities within the tourism sector.

CREATING SEAMLESS AND PERSONALISED EXPERIENCES

In line with changing consumer demands, STB will continue to help our sector sustain their digital momentum, and improve the visitor experience in new ways:

- **Accelerate sector's digital transformation** through guided innovation, support communities and enhanced features in Tourism Information and Service Hub (TIH) and Singapore Tourism Analytics Network (Stan).
- **Explore potential uses of emerging technologies** like 5G and Metaverse to test immersive experiences.
- Increase the number of Singapore Visitor Centres (SVCs) from 10 to 30 by end-2023, to **deliver more personalised services**.


THANK YOU